

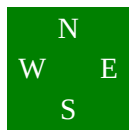
**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6  
 ♥ Q J 10 2  
 ♦ J 10 5 2  
 ♣ 7 4

♠ K Q 3  
 ♥ A K 9 7 5 3  
 ♦ 6  
 ♣ A 5 3



♠ A 9 8 4  
 ♥ 4  
 ♦ K Q 8 7 3  
 ♣ 9 8 6

♠ 7 5 2  
 ♥ 8 6  
 ♦ A 9 4  
 ♣ K Q J 10 2

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1 ♥   | Pass | 2 ♣   |
| Pass     | 3 ♥   | Pass | 4 ♥   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4 ♥ by North

you to ruff a ♦, leaving you with ♥ 9 7. Use one of them to force out West's ♥ Q. You still have a trump left to stop their ♦s, and as soon as you get the lead you can now run dummy's ♣ suit safely.

Suppose you had not driven out both of West's high trumps.

He would have ruffed the third ♣, before you could discard a ♠ loser from your hand. You would lose two trumps and two ♠s.

North is to play 4 ♥. East leads the ♦ K.

Losers: ♠ = 2 ♥ = 1 or 2 ♦ = 0 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 or 4

In fact if trumps split 5-0 you could have 3 losers in the suit and a disaster. So we won't worry about that possibility. Since the most likely scenario is a 3-2 split you should plan on taking the ♥ A K, then driving out their master trump so you can run dummy's ♣s without somebody ruffing in.

Bad news. East discards a ♦ on the second ♥ lead. Time for a change in plans?

Actually, no. West has 2 master trumps at this point but you still have ♥ 9 7 5 3. So use one of your little ones to drive out West's ♥ J. He will probably force out West's ♥ Q. You still have a trump left to stop their ♦s, and as soon as you get the lead you can now run dummy's ♣ suit safely.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 6 3  
 ♥ J 5 2  
 ♦ K Q 3  
 ♣ K 6 4

♠ A K  
 ♥ Q 10 9 4  
 ♦ J 10 8 2  
 ♣ Q 7 2



♠ J 9 7 5 4 2  
 ♥ A K  
 ♦ 7 4  
 ♣ A 5 3

♠ 8  
 ♥ 8 7 6 3  
 ♦ A 9 6 5  
 ♣ J 10 9 8

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       | 1 ♠  | Pass  |
| 3 ♠      | Pass  | 4 ♠  |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4 ♠ by East

The correct procedure is to win the ♣A, and immediately play a ♦ to dummy's ♦Q, which holds the trick. Return to your hand with a ♥, and play another ♦ toward dummy. Suppose South takes his ♦A on this trick (otherwise you have no ♦ loser). He can now play a ♣ but you win with dummy's ♣K and discard your small ♣ on dummy's ♦K.

Only then do you lead trumps.

This is the perfect example of when you delay leading trumps.

When you need to do something else first - in this case, to establish a ♦s winner early.

East is to play 4 ♠. South leads the ♣J.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 4

Unless the defense slips you are going to lose the Ace and King of trumps. And the ♦A is a Fast loser that they can take whenever they want to, so that means you must try to dispose of your ♣ loser. The only realistic hope is that South holds the ♦A and you can lead through it twice. So after you win your ♣A do you play a trump?

As much as you'd like to get the trumps out you must work on the ♦s first. Because if you play even one trump the defense will win it and force out your remaining ♣ stopper before you have established a ♦ winner for the discard.